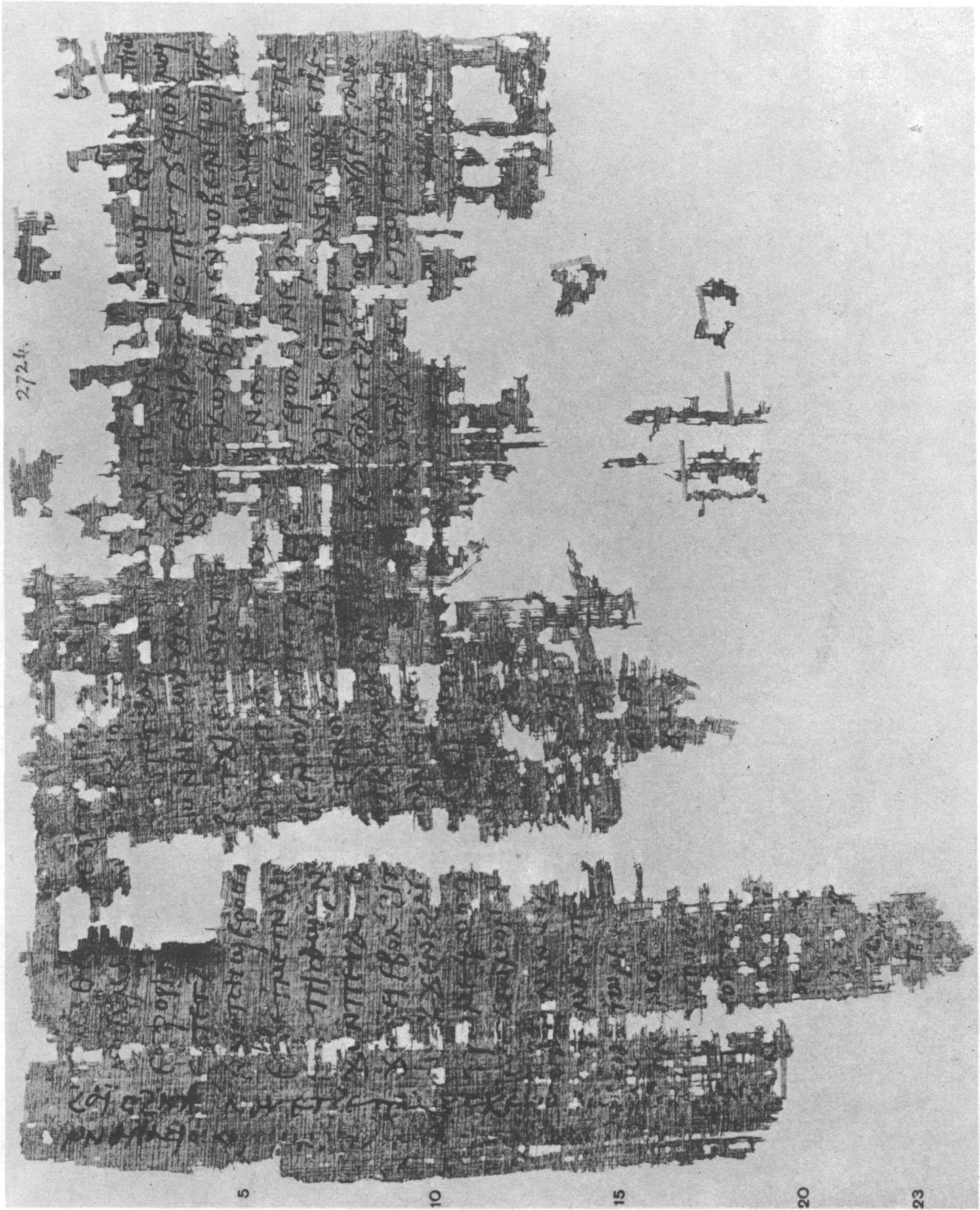






A Meletian Letter.  
(Brit. Mus. Papyrus 2724).  
Scale :  $\frac{1}{3}$ .

20 ]рнтп[  
 ]. н . . р[  
 ]. τωα[  
 ]. πη.[

Along left margin

25 ραῖςρηт πακ εἰθέπαῖ θεκεκω παῖ εἰολ παποῖ[ε  
 μπαπα διосκορος μπαπα γεροντ<sup>1</sup> μπᾶνμητρίος . . . †[

*Verso* (at right-angles to text on *recto*)<sup>2</sup>

† τιμοθεος πετρωαῖ ππεμεριτ π . . .<sup>3</sup>  
 — — — παῖνωτ

"Timotheus that writeth unto his beloved<sup>4</sup>....., brother(?)-loving, righteousness-loving (-δικαιοσύνη)<sup>5</sup>.....who beareth (φορεῖν)...<sup>6</sup>; who hath renounced worldly things (κόσμος), looking toward things heavenly; who hath [renounced] things that perish, looking toward things imperishable; who humbleth himself unto such as be unworthy of him<sup>7</sup> because of the height of heaven<sup>8</sup>; who forgiveth the sins of his children because of God's mercy; who forgiveth the trespasses (παράπτωμα) of his brethren (?) because of the seventy-times seven<sup>9</sup>; who forgiveth the debts of his.....because of the word of the Gospel<sup>10</sup>. So now, my father, I write unto thee, beseeching (παρακαλεῖν) thee; for when I quitted thee<sup>11</sup> thou wast grieved because of the lie that I had told. So now I would have thee know that I told it not intending deception, but (ἀλλά) I told it because of human shame<sup>12</sup>. For (γάρ) God knoweth, that shall give.....of men whether Yea or Nay<sup>13</sup>. I beseech (παρακαλεῖν) [thee], then,.....for]give the sins...because of [the word? of the Gos]pel(?)[.....]"

Translation of ll. 15-23 is impossible. In 15 "concerning the bricks" may be read. In 17 the name "Apa Prow" seems to occur, in 18 "Anoup." L. 24 "...I wrote unto thee for this, that thou shouldest forgive me my sins....." (25) "and Apa Dioscorus and Apa Gerontius (?) and (?) Demetrius (?)...."

*Verso*. "Timotheus that writeth unto his beloved [father?] Paiêw."

The extant contents of the above letter are not important. Timothy, its writer, is concerned to persuade Paiêw<sup>14</sup> that a falsehood, whereof he had been lately guilty, was due, not to premeditated guile, but merely to an impulse of timidity. The first eight lines

<sup>1</sup> ρερ- very doubtful; cf. ρ in l. 8. After π not †.

<sup>2</sup> The strokes above and below ρωα are precisely half-way across the sheet and indicate the point at which the binding ribbon crossed the papyrus when folded.

<sup>3</sup> Room for ιωτ.

<sup>4</sup> "father," or "lord," or both.

<sup>5</sup> I do not remember this epithet elsewhere.

<sup>6</sup> Neither "Christ-bearing," so common in monkish letters (*Mon. of Epiphanius*, II, 373, *C.O.*, 50, n., etc.), nor "verily (ῥησμε) Christ-bearing," seems possible here.

<sup>7</sup> Cf. Sirach xxv, 8 (11), ed. H. Thompson, πετρησῶ ερωγ ἀνάξιος αὐτοῦ.

<sup>8</sup> Reminiscent? of Lu. xiv, 11, or Ja. iv, 10.

<sup>9</sup> Mat. xviii, 22.

<sup>10</sup> Mat. vi, 12.

<sup>11</sup> *Lit.* "I quitted thee, thou being grieved."

<sup>12</sup> *Lit.* "the shame of humanity," man's natural timidity.

<sup>13</sup> Reading ρε...ρε..., rather than ρε...ρεπ (= ριπ). A reference to some biblical verse?

<sup>14</sup> I think that Holl (Berlin *Sitzb.*, 1925, III, 18) must be right (*pace* BELL, *J.C.*, 51) in identifying Παηούς-Paiêw with Παγεῖς of P. 1913. Cf. 'Ερεῖς='Εργεῖς (GRIFFITH, *Rylands Demot. Pap.*, III, 190), 'Ιεούλ=Ιενοῦλ (Gen. xxxvi, 18, Munier).

are occupied with rather extravagant appeals to the recipient's reputation for clemency. Something more concrete may have followed—in l. 15 bricks are in question and in 17, 18 other persons are referred to. The letter ends (l. 24) with a final request for forgiveness.

Paiêw is clearly, here as elsewhere, a venerated personage, with moral authority in his community<sup>1</sup>. Timothy, his supplicant—not necessarily himself a monk—occurs here only. Prow (l. 17) is presumably the monk greeted in P. 1914, 52<sup>2</sup>; Anoup (l. 18) might be the Anoubas of the same letter. A Dioscorus (l. 25) is likewise greeted in PP. 1916, 1918, 1921, and with him, as here, a Gerontius in P. 1918.

More interesting than what Timothy says is the idiom in which he says it: archaic (as might be expected in an unliterary text of the early part of the fourth century) and in some points comparable with that of the contemporary P. 1922<sup>3</sup>. Conspicuous in both is the perfect tense prefix *ḡa-* etc., for *a-*. Here we find it as pluperfect *neḡai-* (10), relative *eṡeḡai-* (9), *petḡaq-* (3, 4) and presumably perfect *ḡai-* (24)<sup>4</sup>. Additional instances of this prefix known to me are: *Acta Pauli*, where *ḡa-* is frequent, but only before a nominal subject<sup>5</sup>; the Oxyrhynchus fragment of Romans, printed at the end of this article, as perfect and pluperfect; an early and interesting fragment, also from Oxyrhynchus, in the Hoskyns collection at Cambridge, *ḡaq-*, *ḡat-*; B.M. 1111 (an otherwise Sa'idic text) *ḡa-* once; Ryl. 415 (Fayyûmic); *Z.N.T.W.*, 1925, 84, 88 = *J.T.St.*, 25, 226, 229; B.M. 580, 5, 6 relat. *petḡak-*, *petḡaṡ-*, but context obscure. It appears to characterize an early stage of the idiom current throughout Middle Egypt and perhaps further south (*Acta Pauli*)<sup>6</sup>. Further to be noted are the hybrid forms *seḡe* (7)<sup>7</sup>, *met-* (6, cf. *met-* 10), *meṡte* (10), *neṡte* (3), *ṡeḡio* (4); the use of *seḡnt* as absolute (24)<sup>8</sup>; the unusual *petṡat* (4, cf. *R.O.C.*, 1914, 73 *petṡaḡtame*, Cod. Morgan 31, 122 *petṡareṡḡoic taḡaḡ*); the Bohairic use of *nte* (6) and of the forms *tot-*, *ḡos*; also the doubled consonant in *totṡk* (9), as often in P. 1922, while in *petḡ-* (5, 6) an *n-* is omitted.

The only novelty to be had from this letter is *ḡloṡie* (7), a plural form comparable to Achm. *toṡeie* (Sa<sup>c</sup>. *toṡin*). One might expect it here to mean "debtors," or something of the sort; but I would suggest that it is the plural of *ḡel* "servant," whereof elsewhere the singular form does duty as plural (Mt. xiii, 27, Apoc. vi, 15, Cod. Morgan 30, 51).

To the Coptic references to the Meletians already given<sup>9</sup>, I can add:

(1) The patriarch Alexander, in his Encomium on Peter I<sup>10</sup>, declares that Melitius (*μελιτιος*) aimed at (*ἐπιθυμείν*) nothing short of the archbishopric, in Peter's absence.

<sup>1</sup> BELL, *J.C.*, 43.

<sup>2</sup> *J.C.*, 70. The name is that of a saint invoked upon several gravestones from Middle Egypt: QUIBELL-THOMPSON, *Sagqara*, 1912, 61, n. 6, PEET, *Cemet. of Abydos*, III, 38, G. MASPERO, *Musée égypt.*, II, Pl. xvi, TURABIEF, *Materiale*, no. 54. Perhaps the same name as *πλωστ*, *C.S.C.O.*, 43, 202 (so, not as ZOEGLA, 30, *απολλω*, thanks to Mgr. Hebbelynck's collation) and as *πρωστ* the martyr, HYVERNAT, *Actes*, 135.

<sup>3</sup> *J.C.*, 97.

<sup>4</sup> The reference, *op. cit.*, 97, to *Wadi Sarga*, needs correction: for *Zeitschr. f. äg. Spr.*, 1915, read 1914. Moreover Sethe pointed out (letter 8. 5. 23) that, in Job xxx, 9, the tense is present, not perfect.

<sup>5</sup> Note on p. R<sup>2</sup> 21, *eḡa-*.

<sup>6</sup> Another abnormal, but merely phonetic *h* is found in Achmimic, separating vowels: *otaḡet*-Hos. viii, 4, Jo. xii, 9, *ḡaraḡw* Clement iv, 10, *caḡotṡam* Zech. iii, 1; as in Sa'idic also: *maḡiḡam*, *maḡiḡam*, *otḡaḡei* KRALL, cxvi, *otḡwṡḡ* B.M. 1123. In *ḡaraḡl*, *ḡaḡaraḡam*, *poṡḡeem* *Zeitschr. f. äg. Spr.*, LV, 71, *h* represents *ʿain*, as often in modern Egyptian Arabic.

<sup>7</sup> Also in the Subachmimic St. John and in the above-mentioned Hoskyns fragment.

<sup>8</sup> Cf. *seṡ* B.M. 580, 599, *seṡnt* 1227, *seṡnt* CRUM, *Copt. MSS.*, xxxi; all Fayyûmic.

<sup>9</sup> *J.C.*, 41-43.

<sup>10</sup> HYVERNAT, *Actes*, 260.

Compare the words of the Hamburg text of the *Patriarchal History*<sup>1</sup>: “And M., bishop of Asiût, descended upon (وٲب) the city of Alexandria and entered it, bringing money, which he distributed among a few folk, weak in faith and understanding; and they received him and he became their leader; and he found favour (اصلح) with the clergy and carried out ordinations of bishops (للاساقة).” On this last matter cf. the Athanasian Epistle printed below.

(2) “Whoso saith that the Meletians (or Melitius) have a church, the same is accursed.” So says the twenty-fifth of the Canons ascribed to Athanasius<sup>2</sup>.

(3) But church discipline was evidently no longer the main ground of contention with the Meletians in later times; doctrinal heresies—presumably resulting from their fusion with the Arians—were ascribed to them, as can be seen in the sixth-seventh century Encomium by Constantine of Siut on the martyr Claudius<sup>3</sup>, a phrase from which is: “Flee the Meletians, that divide the indivisible Christ”; while the author, shortly before, tells how the Meletians “taught not to recite (μελετᾶν) from the Scriptures, but to say, ‘The Father, the Son, the Holy Ghost,’ dividing them one from another,” whereas “the faithful (πιστός) divide not the Holy Trinity<sup>4</sup>.” This same Encomium relates elsewhere<sup>5</sup> that these heretics practised various abominations, such as using defiled animals for food. Sorcery too they were accused of, as we learn from the tales of their evil-doings current in the eighth century<sup>6</sup>.

(4) Heretical too were their doctrines as to the bodily Assumption of the Virgin<sup>7</sup>.

(5) The Twelfth Athanasian Canon forbids the singing of the hymns composed by “the Meletians and the ignorant and wandering (monks)<sup>8</sup>,” showing that, like the Arians, their innovations extended to liturgical matters.

(6) The disciples of St. Antony protested against being confounded with Meletian monks<sup>9</sup> and the Pachomian communities must have suffered from these heretics; for Horsiese, in his vision of hell, saw “those that had renounced the Apostles’ teaching and hearkened to the Meletians<sup>10</sup>.”

(7) Shenoute (ob. 451) reprobates the Meletians<sup>11</sup>, “those brute-beasts,” that take the sacrament up to 18 times a day, devouring it as bodily food; by whom many “of us” have been led astray (cf. the experience of Damianus, *J.C.*, 42), and he seems to refer to them as allies (κοινωνός) of the Arians<sup>12</sup>. In his *Apocalypse* we read (perhaps) of a Meletian soul seen in hell<sup>13</sup>.

(8) Not the least interesting reference is that, again from bishop Constantine’s Encomium<sup>14</sup>, wherein a priest confesses his unorthodoxy: “Thus have I secretly believed, thus taught me Marcion and that deceiver (πλάνως) Pilates (πυλατῆς), the authors (ἀρχηγός) of the heresy of Melitius (μελιτιος).” To find a seventh-century writer making Marcion responsible for the Meletian “heresy” is perhaps not more surprising than many other historical confusions whereof Coptic writers of that age are guilty. But who is

<sup>1</sup> Ed. Seybold, 42, *supra*; not in Evetts’s MSS.

<sup>2</sup> Ed. Riedel and Crum, 30.

<sup>3</sup> *J.C.*, 42.

<sup>4</sup> This from the B.M. fragt. of the text (no. 358).

<sup>5</sup> Cod. Morgan 47, 154.

<sup>6</sup> *P.O.*, v, 200.

<sup>7</sup> CRUM, *Theol. Texts*, 11 n., 13 n.

<sup>8</sup> *Op. cit.*, 24, cf. Arabic text, p. 18. The rare word *σαρακωτε* (comparable perhaps to *sarabaitae*)

may designate the *girovagi*, of whom the orthodox church always disapproved. The preceding *جبال* would then be a mere guess at its translation.

<sup>9</sup> *Mission franç.*, iv, 572.

<sup>10</sup> WESSELY, *Stud.*, xviii, 52, translated by W. HENGSTENBERG in *Festgabe A. Ehrhard*, 1922, 229.

<sup>11</sup> *Rev. ég.*, xi, 17.

<sup>12</sup> Paris, 130<sup>5</sup>, 28; LEIPOLDT, *Schenute*, 87.

<sup>13</sup> *C.S.C.O.*, 73, 202.

<sup>14</sup> Cod. Morgan 47, 185.

Pilates? No trace of any one so named is discoverable in the church historians, nor does plausible emendation suggest itself. It is however to be noted that not only is Πιλᾶτος a not uncommon name among Egyptian Christians of the sixth-seventh centuries<sup>1</sup>, but that this very form, Pilates, is twice met with<sup>2</sup>. Only once does the name occur in the Theban neighbourhood<sup>3</sup>, once (presumably) in the north<sup>4</sup>; all other occurrences are from Middle Egypt, *i.e.*, from the provinces lying, say, between Achmim and the Fayyûm. This may be due to mere accident, but it seems more likely to indicate that the name was native to the middle country—where in fact the Meletian schism originated and appears to have maintained itself<sup>5</sup>. One is tempted to wonder whether the names Melitius and Pilatus (Pilates) may not be one and the same, the former—otherwise scarcely known in Egypt<sup>6</sup>—perhaps a euphemistic manipulation of the latter, whose biblical associations may have rendered it ill-omened for a bishop<sup>7</sup>.

This name "Pilatus" cannot but recall the tradition, lurking evidently in the Egyptian form of the Pilate legend<sup>8</sup>, that the procurator of Judea had in fact been of Egyptian origin. Of this claim—one is reminded of Jean Maspero's observations on Coptic national vanity<sup>9</sup>—traces may be seen in the Egyptian (Arabic) version of the *Gesta Pilati*, where the angry Jews appeal to Herod against "Pilate the king (*sic*), the wicked foreigner from the land of Egypt<sup>10</sup>"; and again, in speaking to Tiberius's envoy of Pilate's defence: "What profit thee his words, seeing he lieth unto thee in the Egyptian (Coptic) tongue<sup>11</sup>?" See too Herod's contemptuous words: "A man of Pontus art thou, a Galilean (= Christian), a foreigner (ἀλλόφυλος) and Egyptian<sup>12</sup>." [Only when this was in print did I discover that E. Galtier had noted it and edited the Arabic text: *Mém. Inst. Franç.*, xxvii.]

(9) Athanasius, in two at least of his Festal Epistles, finds occasion to condemn Meletian iniquities: in the thirty-ninth<sup>13</sup> he speaks of the apocryphal scriptures of which they boasted and in another<sup>14</sup> he reprobates their sacrilegious traffic in martyrs' relics: "An

<sup>1</sup> Coptic texts: Ryl. 250, 338 (Siut?), KRALL, CLXVIII (Heracleop.), *Sagqara ut supr.*, no. 182; Greek texts: B.M. (Copt. Cat.), nos. 1075, 1076 (Hermop.), P. Lond., iv, no. 1419, v, no. 1661 (Aphrod.), P. Cairo, *saepe* (do.).

<sup>2</sup> CLÉDAT, *Baouit*, II, 159 and a Balaiza fragt. (Bodleian Copt. (P.) d 17).

<sup>3</sup> WINLOCK and CRUM, *Monast. of Epiphanius*, no. 217. ΠΙΛΟΤΕ *Jême* 90, 28, seems more likely = ΦΙΛΟΘΕΟΣ; so too? ΠΗΛΟΤΤΟΣ Lefebvre no. 402.

<sup>4</sup> HORNER's *Bohairic New Test.*, I, p. cviii, in a modern MS. of unknown provenance.

<sup>5</sup> Though Melitius in his *Brief* does indeed claim followers throughout the length of Egypt.

<sup>6</sup> Cf. PREISIGKE's *Namenbuch*, 212.

<sup>7</sup> Initial π- is now and then replaced by μ- in Coptic, and oftenest in Middle Egypt; cf. *Monast. of Epiphanius*, I, 243, *infra*.

<sup>8</sup> Fantastic developments whereof appear in a homily of Pseudo-Cyril Hieros., Cod. Morgan 44, 40 ff.

<sup>9</sup> *Hist. des Patriarches*, 24 ff.

<sup>10</sup> Cod. Vat. Syr. (Karshûni) 199, 351 (from photographs lent me, years ago, by Prof. von Dobschütz) ملك الغرب الذي من ديار مصر. The Ethiopic translation has Πιλᾶτος μαῦραῖ (B.M., Or. 690, 99a), "P. the magician," doubtless merely ill transcribed from مصري "the Egyptian." Melkite tradition did not apparently accept this; Eutychius gives Pilate an Italian origin: from an isle near Rome, named Ποντα *بنطة* (ed. Cheikho in *C.S.C.O.*, I, 91).

<sup>11</sup> Paris arabe 152, 15a, *ما فائدتك بكلمه وهو يقتري عليك باللغة القبطية*.

<sup>12</sup> GUIDI, *Fram. Copti*, 97 = FORBES ROBINSON, *Copt. Apocr. Gosp.*, 177 (v. 243) = P.O., II, 152. Similarly, though with more justification, the Copts make of Herod a Saracen: Paris 129<sup>18</sup>, 153, σπνος μπραγμα-τετης πσαραγενος (Br. Mus. Cat., 220 n.), Rossi, II, IV, 15, *ζηρωανς πσαρακινος*.

<sup>13</sup> Ed. CARL SCHMIDT, *Göttinger Nachr.*, 1901, 326 ff.

<sup>14</sup> ZOEGA, CCLXXVII, fol. 2 (pp. 215, 216). That this is from the Festal Epistles is proved by its duplicate, Paris 129<sup>14</sup>, 90, one of four leaves (pp. 18, 19; 29, 30; 47, 48; [193], 194 respectively), from the same

iniquity (πονηρία) it is to take toll of (?)<sup>1</sup> and to rob (συλᾶν) the martyrs' tombs and not to bury them like the saints, and before all, like the Lord.....Who doth behold the corpses of the martyrs and the prophets, cast out and exposed, and trembleth not? No Christian work is this; Paul hath not enjoined it upon us, neither did patriarchs thus, nor prophets aforetime (κατὰ καιρόν); but the Meletians it was devised these things for gain. For this is after the manner of Jeroboam's guile, which selleth doves and taketh change (κόλλυβος)<sup>2</sup> in the temple of God."

It may in this connexion be noted that bishop Constantine, in the above-cited *Encomium*<sup>3</sup>, recalls how Melitius himself had attempted to carry with him the martyr Claudius's body, when he went northward.

That a further passage from the Epistles remained, still unpublished, at Oxford was known since Prof. Schmidt edited one of the two leaves. As he obligingly renounces in my favour his former intention to edit the other, I print it here; for, to me at least, it appears to be concerned with the activities of the Meletian bishops, intrusively ordaining clerics in dioceses not their own. To which Epistle this passage belongs it is difficult to say with certainty; the gap of eight pages between Schmidt's leaf (pp. 185, 186) and this one (pp. 195, 196) might be sufficiently filled by the final words of Epistle 39 and the first portion of 40 (A.D. 368); at most we may here have reached no. 41 (A.D. 369). The MS. is by the scribe of Brit. Mus., no. 363 and the other leaves there enumerated and may be of the ninth or tenth century.

Clarendon Press no. 50, fol. 2. P. ῤῥῥ. Χει]ρονοει ἡρεγκληρικος ερεπτοш εποτοш αππε-  
 παι δε ἡκελαατ αππε ἡσαλωκ̄ ατω εοτωμ ἡπεπερητ • ατω εωχῆ ἡπεπερητ • ετῡαν-  
 τμλο ετειρε ἡπειρωῆ εβολ γαρ ῥῡτεπαραιομια ἡτειμινε • ῡαρεοτ'τοττωπ (*sic*) ῡωπε  
 ἡποτκωρ ἡποτπαροζ'τοςμος • ἡπῡσως ρεηλοισε μπωρ'x παι ῡατῡτοτ'τ'ρ ριτοοτοτ ἡσι  
 ἡκεεκκλησια οταατ απ • αλλα ἡκεμοναστηριον • απεαςωοτ γαρ ἡτειμινε πωρ ῡαρωοτ  
 ρωοτ • πμ ρωοτπε πταγ'τ πειρωῆ ετοοτοτ • η ἡτατ'сабо epai ριτ'паш ἡтрафи ἡсенаш  
 οτωшῆ απ мптаτ πετοτпажооγ γαρ αλλα μαλλον ετειρε ἡπαῖ ετ'εοτρητ' εтсωк ἡμοοτ  
 етапата ἡμοοτ ριτ'пτεπεп'омια ἡμιν ἡμοοτ • ἡка γαρ πм аре ра'тῡ ῥ'поττωш epапотῡ •  
 ατω ποτα ποτα ῥ'псωпт беет ἡе птаткааγ ἡμογ ката θε етснр • απρη сотῡ пегма  
 ἡρωтῡ ατω ποор eyраpеr ἡтархн ἡтетшн емеγотет'к пегтош • ατω ἡμοотпейооте мен  
 аqкω пат ποттош ἡпетсаа'тῡ • ката пшаже ἡпешаλ[μω]зос • οτε ἡпеткотоτ ере'к̄  
 пка[р.] ἡтотейн де • аqш'тот ῥ'поτшн ατω пекрωοτ ρποтмаше • пс[ωма] (P. ῤῥῥ) ката θε  
 етqжω ἡмос п'и пат'лос аqс'ткера ἡмоγ ἡси ппотте • еаγ'т ποт'аcio ἡροто ἡпет'созх  
 жекас ἡпепωрх ῡωпе ἡрн'тῡ • αλλα ἡτεἰμμελος qи роотш ρапетернτ • οткотп епейан  
 псωпт тнрот тнш ка'лос ατω мп лааτ ж епетρ'ιτοτωγ • οτε ἡсетωрп απ ἡпexриa  
 ἡпетернτ αλλα пeр'н'те ἡпекк'лнcia οп'таτ пeт'к'лнpос ἡμιν ἡмоот ἡмаτ • паш пpe  
 от'рωῆ απ еγμεr ἡшпe петотейре ἡмоγ ἡси ποт'ннῡ • η паш ἡре мп ота пашп аpикe  
 epон з'ка'лос epраpеr απ ептош ἡтаτ'тааτ пап • αλλα от'т'иминε απпе пeс'мoт ἡпa'лос •  
 ἡтeрeγжωк γαρ εβολ ἡта'закон'иa ἡта'т'таас етоο'тῡ • аqш'отшот ἡмоγ аγ'т с'кω пап етpeп'т  
 рнτ • qс'раῖ γαρ ἡп'кoрп'нос еγжω ἡмос жeп'т'пашотшот μμοι απ п'ноλ ἡпшн • αλλα ка'та  
 пшн ἡп'кап'пон ἡтап'пoт'те тошῡ пап етpeп'пωр ῡаошн ῡаpωтп ρωт'т'н'тῡ • птапр θε  
 γαρ απ ἡпeт'е'пeп'нr ῡаpωтῡ • ап[пoр]шпн εβολ ап'пωр ῡаpωтῡ ῡм[пeтa]т'тeл'иoп ἡпe'xс  
 ἡпeпш'отшот [ἡмо]п απ п'ноλ мшн • ῥ'пpeп'иce (*sic expl.*).

MS. as B.M. 173 (pp. 213-220; pagination in several cases altered, hence its apparent duplication here). The Paris leaves preserve beginnings and ends of at least two Epistles, but f. 90 is not among these.

<sup>1</sup> *шгге* means to demand a tax, or alms (*ἀπαρτείν* usually). But possibly it here = *шгге* "dig up," as in Achm. Prov. xxvi, 27, Zach. iii, 9 (*v. TILL, Zeitschr. f. äg. Spr., LXII, 126*).

<sup>2</sup> As in Mt. xxi, 12.

<sup>3</sup> Cod. Morgan 47, 153.

“...ordain (χειροτ.) clerics (κληρικός) to dioceses other than their (the bishops’) own. But this is naught else than biting and devouring one another and destroying one another, unless they cease to do this thing. For (γάρ) from unlawfulness (παρανομία) such as this come strife and envy and irritation (παροξυσμός), thereafter causes of disruption. Whereby not the churches (ἐκ.) alone are upset, but the monasteries (μονασ.) likewise; for them also hath the aforesaid recklessness<sup>1</sup> attained to. And who is it hath enjoined this thing upon them, or from what scripture (γραφή) have they been taught this? They will not be able to answer, for they have naught to say. But rather (ἀλλὰ μᾶλλον) they do this for gain<sup>2</sup>, being enticed and beguiled (ἀπατᾶν) through their own lusts (ἐπιθυμία). For (γάρ) everything standeth in a right (lit. good) order and each created thing abideth even as it hath been set, as it is written<sup>3</sup>: the sun knoweth his place of going down and the moon doth hold the governance (ἀρχή) of the night<sup>4</sup>, overstepping not his limits; and for the waters likewise He hath set a limit which they may not exceed, according to the Psalmist’s words<sup>5</sup>, nor may they return to cover the earth. And the mountains hath He measured with a measure and the valleys with a balance<sup>6</sup>; the body (σῶμα), (p. 195) even as Paul saith<sup>7</sup>, hath God compounded (συγκερανύναι), having given greater honour unto the (part) which lacketh, so that there be therein no schism, but that the members (μέλ.) should have care one for another. So then (οὕκουν), seeing that (ἐπειδή) all creatures are rightly (καλῶς) ordered and there is none interfereth with<sup>8</sup> his neighbour, neither seize they on the business (χρεία) one of another, but (ἀλλά) that the affairs of the churches (likewise) have their own allotted-parts (κληρος)—how is it not a shameful thing which the priests<sup>9</sup> do, or how shall not any one justly (δικαίως) blame us, if we observe not the limits that have been set us? But (ἀλλὰ) not such was Paul; for after that he had fulfilled the ministry (διακ.) that had been committed unto him, he boasted and taught us, that we might have profit. For he writeth to the Corinthians, saying<sup>10</sup>: ‘I will not boast’” (*sic expl.*).

I will conclude with the fragment of Romans referred to on p. 21 above. It was found by Messrs. Grenfell and Hunt at Oxyrhynchus, in the early years of their work there and is written on vellum, in “fine, early uncials”—such is all that my copy, made at the time, has to tell. Professor Hunt kindly assents to my printing it.

The version clearly approximates to the Sa’idic, though divergent in detail. In 16 εβαλ and ετρε- recall the Bohairic, while ποταν νιμ, etc., is perhaps due to i, 16. In 17 ατα is characteristic of the dialect, and in 19 ποψς πρητ (usually ἀφιστάναι, ἐξιστάναι) is remarkable<sup>11</sup>. For Sa’. κα σομ in that verse one might here read ασοπει. The use of πκα- in 24 for ἀλλά would be unique, preceding another preposition. Perhaps misread by me for αλλα.

<sup>1</sup> The qual. of ασαι thus, as a noun, is unknown to me elsewhere (*cf.* STERN, § 349, *sub fin.*). Evidently in an abstract sense; a “reckless person” would here seem incongruous. And yet the word cannot but remind us of the epithets used of Melitius himself in the Synodal Letter to the Alexandrine clergy (Socrates, i, 9=Theodoret, i, 9): τὸ πρόχειρον καὶ προπετὲς τῆς γνώμης. I do not understand this reference to monasteries.

<sup>2</sup> Or “advantage,” “profit.”

<sup>3</sup> Ps. ciii, 19.

<sup>4</sup> This reading is presumably a reminiscence of Gen. i, 16.

<sup>5</sup> *Cf.* Ps. ciii, 9.

<sup>6</sup> Is. xl, 12.

<sup>7</sup> 1 Cor. xii, 24.

<sup>8</sup> πῖ ε- διαφέρειν, μέλειν. Comparable to this is C.S.C.O., 73, 209: οπν ρωμε μματ εφπαχι επετρίτωσ, presumably in a similar sense, though the context is aphoristic and rather obscure.

<sup>9</sup> “Priests” perhaps stands for priesthood, including the bishops.

<sup>10</sup> 2 Cor. x, 13–15 (text practically as in Horner).

<sup>11</sup> It recalls Boh. Ac., iii, 10 μετεβη εκστασις=Sa’. ατπωψς, while 2 Kgs. iii, 1 ρ ρηλε=ἀσθενεῖν.

Journ. of Egypt. Arch. XIII.



*Recto.*

iv. 15      пом]ос  
           [п̄рнт]ϣ от̄ае'  
           [μм]п параба  
 16 [сi]с ет̄неп̄и  
           [е]баал ϣит̄пт̄и  
           стис · жекес  
           [к]ата от̄рмат  
           ет̄реперрнт  
           щопе еϣжарн  
           от̄т̄ п̄ота̄н̄ п̄[им]  
           ет̄пт̄ст̄ет̄е ·  
                   ] . . [

17 [же]раїне[ек пиот]      +·п̄от̄ата̄ п̄[ре̄θпос]  
           +·μп̄емта̄ ēh[ал]  
           +·μп̄п̄т̄ · ēθαϣп̄[и]  
           стеот̄е' ēр[аϣ ·]  
           п̄еї ет̄та̄[п̄ра]  
           п̄пет[  
           ēт̄м̄от̄те  
           [п̄с]е[  
 18 [ . ] ϣωс[      [ . ] ϣαϣп̄[ист̄ет̄е']  
           [εт̄]ре[λп̄ис

*Verso.*

19 μма]с · аτω  
           [μп̄]ϣпошс̄ п̄рнт̄  
           [ϣ]пт̄п̄ист̄ис ·  
           ραϣпет̄ еп̄еϣ  
           сωма̄ жеαϣ[  
                   ]еї еϣρп̄ш[е]  
           [п̄рам]п̄е · аτω  
                   ]ρωс[  
                   ]ан[  
           ]перрнт[  
 20 [μп̄п̄]т̄ μп̄ϣ[  
                   ]ме[

μм[аϣ  
 22 ēт̄не[п̄еї ρаτ]  
           апс̄ ераϣ [εт̄а̄и]  
           κᾱῑο̄с̄т̄п̄[и ·]  
 23 Н̄ερατ̄с̄ρ̄еї[т̄ϣ̄ а̄е]  
           еп̄ ет̄һ̄нт̄ϣ  
           ēот̄а̄еϣ̄ жеρατ̄  
 24 апс̄ ēраϣ · п̄са  
           ēт̄һ̄нт̄п̄ ϣωп̄  
           ап̄ · п̄еї ēт̄от̄  
           п̄ε̄апс̄̄ ер̄[аτ̄]  
           п̄[εт̄